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Building a six-figure empire, from her dorm

For online influencers, campuses offer fertile terrain

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — If you want to interview Amherst College influencer Grace Nah, a.k.a. “your fav blue hair girl,” you have to go through her people. Specifically, her Los Angeles-based talent manager, who coordinates a time for you to meet once Nah is back from spring break in the Dominican Republic. “It was actually a brand trip,”

Nah said upon her return, sitting in her residence hall’s empty common room.

Meaning: Nah worked with the travel company EF Ultimate Break and later shared glimpses of her vacation sunbathing, sightseeing, and drinking piña coladas on TikTok and Instagram, where she has 400,000-plus followers combined. “SO TEA,” one fan commented on her various beach shots, show-

ing her in various bikinis.

For the olds, tea means hot. But the life of a college student influencer isn’t always glamorous. Back in Amherst, Nah, a physics and math major in her sophomore year, was battling a cold, her midnight-blue hair and baggy jeans damp from dashing home in the rain from her thermal biophysics class. She still had homework to do, though

INFLUENCERS, Page A7



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Grace Nah has a full physics and math courseload, a talent manager, corporate partners, and 400,000 followers.

Efforts to limit teens’ screen use chastised

Critics laud intent, but say proposals are awkward, invasive, counterproductive

By Anjali Huynh and Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

In trying to restrict the use of social media by younger children, is Beacon Hill having an “OK, boomer” moment?

That about sums up some of the hot takes concerning the efforts by Governor Maura Healey and lawmakers in the Massachusetts House to curb potentially addictive use of social media among teens and protect them from online exploitation.

Critics say the proposals are variously clumsy and invasive, raise a host of practical, constitutional, and privacy challenges, and may even undercut other efforts to protect young people’s digital presence.

“It does not appear to us that they know what they’re doing,” said Scotia Hille of Act On Mass, a progressive advocacy organization.

The pushback underscores the difficulty of nimbly adjusting to the technological frontier and its impact on society, as well as reflecting on the checkered track record Beacon Hill has on the subject.

“I completely understand the urgency around this issue, and I appreciate that lawmakers want to do something about the harmful and predatory

SOCIAL MEDIA, Page A6

A BANNER DAY FOR BOSTON

Sunday was no day of rest for the Boston sports fan. The Celtics and Bruins kicked off their playoff run with games at the Garden and in Buffalo. The Sox had their uber-ace on the mound at Fenway. And, oh, there’s that little race that was about to start in a few hours. **B1.**



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

CELTICS ROLL
Led by the dynamic duo of Jaylen Brown and Jayson Tatum, Boston romped past the 76ers, 123-91. **C1.**

SOX STAGGER
Starting pitcher Garrett Crochet stumbled once more, as the Sox fell to the Tigers, 6-2. **C1.**

RUNNERS READY
The strongest field ever of US women participants will line up for the 130th running of the Boston Marathon. **C2.**

BRUINS FALTER
Up 2-0 in third period, Boston allowed four unanswered goals from Buffalo. **C1.**

R.I. World Cup runneth over?

In bid to woo fans from Boston, lawmakers mull permitting 24/7 bars

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — More than 2 million visitors from around the world are expected to descend on New England during the World Cup. Providence wants a share of their business, and Rhode Island officials believe they might have an irresistible lure: late-night boozing.

With just 10 weeks until matches start, Rhode Island lawmakers are considering extending closing hours for all bars in the state to 3 or 4 a.m., or even for 24 hours per day, during the Cup.

The proposal is being pitched as a way to help small businesses, but also to compete with Boston. Supporters said longer bar hours could help Providence attract some of those much-needed tourism dollars that might otherwise flow north.

“This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity, the largest sporting event in the world by far. Nothing comes close,” said Representative Joshua Giraldo, a Central Falls Democrat who introduced the bill that would allow all Rhode Island bars with liquor licenses to operate nearly 24/7.

“Our restaurants and businesses really should be able to take advantage and capitalize on that.”

BARS, Page A6

Good for the sole

Monday: Sun, runner’s tailwind.
High 48-53, low 32-37.

Tuesday: More sun.
High 43-48, low 38-43.
Sunrise: 5:55. Sunset: 7:31.
Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **B6.**

Gunman kills 8 children in La.

Rampage left trail of terror in Shreveport neighborhood. **A2.**

Police shot and killed a Lexington man as he approached them with a large knife outside his home, according to the district attorney. **B1.**

President Trump said a new round of peace talks is set for Pakistan, but Iranian officials countered they had not agreed to meet. **A3.**

To future readers: We’re sorry

The intelligence is artificial, our ignorance is real and we blew it

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

Dear future humans:

I write to you from the year 2026, which history will record as the infancy of the age of artificial intelligence. This whole thing is just a few years old for us, but already we humans — do you still have humans? — are beginning to reckon with the genie we have let out of the bottle.

I say “we,” but the truth is only a few people had anything to do with this decision, and I was not consulted. Nor have any of us been presented with the ability to opt out. Just so you don’t hate all of us.

Here’s the funny thing: For

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generations, our novelists and filmmakers have explored this topic inside their brains. We still do that back here in 2026. And each one of them came to the same conclusion about what would happen after we uncork the bottle.

It ends poorly for humans.

The plots are so similar as to be a bit tired. Humans create machines. Humans give machines intelligence. Machines take over humans. Humans must defeat machines.

We’re still at the beginning of this story back here, and I can’t begin to imagine what chapter

you’re on when you read this. But here in 2026, it is the moment where the fear has moved from existential to real, and sticking our fingers in our ears and saying “Nah, nah, nah, nah, I can’t hear you” will not keep us from being swept away in the tsunami. I certainly tried; I even used my thumbs.

Before I go any further, allow me to describe what life is like in 2026, as far as it relates to technology. It’s been roughly two decades since the smartphone entered our world and quickly ended the age of alone, that 300,000ish-year-era where modern Homo sapiens had only their

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